

SHAHZEB ALI

SOC Analyst | Cybersecurity Analyst | SIEM & Incident Response

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UAE Family-Sponsored Residence Visa | Available Immediately | English (Fluent), Urdu (Native)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

SOC Analyst with 2+ years of hands-on experience triaging 150+ daily security alerts across SIEM platforms (Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk, ELK Stack) in regulated healthcare and enterprise environments. Combines defensive SOC operations with offensive security and security tool development. Recognised on YesWeHack for responsibly disclosing a critical Broken Access Control vulnerability in Deezer, and author of an independently built browser-based phishing triage platform with automated MITRE ATT&CK mapping and SIEM hunt query generation. Proven track record reducing false-positive rates below 12%, cutting attacker dwell time by 30%, and contributing directly to HIPAA compliance audit renewal. Deeply versed in MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, and ISO/IEC 27001. UAE-based and immediately available for full-time SOC roles.

CORE COMPETENCIES

SIEM & Monitoring: Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), Microsoft Defender for Cloud, EDR/XDR, SOAR, Snort, Sysmon

Threat Intelligence & Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, Pyramid of Pain, Diamond Model, ISO/IEC 27001, HIPAA

Incident Response: Alert Triage, IOC Extraction, Phishing Analysis, Root Cause Analysis, Containment, Escalation, Post-Incident Reporting, Case Management

Security Tool Development: Browser-based forensic tooling, .eml parsing, IOC extraction pipelines, automated detection rule engineering, KQL/SPL query generation, STIX 2.1

Log Analysis: Windows Event Logs, Linux Syslog, Firewall Logs, IDS/IPS Alerts, Azure AD Sign-in Logs, DNS Logs, Web Activity Logs, Cloud Trails

Offensive Security: Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, Hydra, Gobuster, OWASP Top 10, API Security Testing, Vulnerability Assessment, Responsible Disclosure

Network & Forensics: Wireshark, TCP/IP, DNS Tunnelling Detection, Packet Analysis, OSI Model, HTTP/S, Memory & Endpoint Forensics

Systems & Scripting: Windows Internals, Linux CLI, Active Directory, PowerShell, Python, Bash, JavaScript/React, Privilege Escalation Analysis

GRC & Soft Skills: Security Awareness Programme Design, RBAC, Audit Support, Documentation, Cross-Team Collaboration, Shift Handover

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst (Level 1), CureMD, Healthcare Technology

Dec 2022 to Jul 2024

Lahore, Pakistan

- Monitored and triaged 150+ daily security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel, EDR, and Microsoft Defender for Cloud, sustaining a false-positive rate below 12% through structured severity classification and endpoint baseline profiling.
- Deployed Sysmon across critical healthcare endpoints and authored custom detection rules surfacing Living-off-the-Land (LotL) tactics, reducing estimated attacker dwell time by 30%.
- Investigated phishing campaigns, credential-based intrusions, and lateral movement activity; escalated fully-documented cases to L2/L3 analysts with an average mean time to escalate (MTTE) of 25 minutes.
- Correlated Windows Event Logs, Azure AD audit logs, and cloud trails against MITRE ATT&CK techniques, producing structured threat intelligence reports consumed by senior analysts and the CISO.
- Contributed to HIPAA compliance audit renewal by collaborating with DevSecOps to harden cloud infrastructure configurations and close identified control gaps.
- Designed and ran bi-monthly phishing simulation campaigns, achieving a 40% reduction in click-through rates across high-risk business units within two quarters.

SOC Analyst (Level 1), Internship, Arwen Tech

Feb 2022 to Aug 2022

Lahore, Pakistan

- Triaged 100+ daily security events from SIEM, IDS/IPS, and perimeter firewalls; implemented a severity classification framework that reduced average escalation time by 20%.
- Correlated firewall and endpoint logs in Splunk against MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, identifying and containing multiple IOCs before progression to active exploitation stages.
- Distinguished true positives from false positives through structured initial analysis, delivering complete case files to L2/L3 analysts and reducing duplicated investigation effort across shifts.
- Proposed three detection rule optimisations during post-incident reviews, all of which were adopted into the team's standard SOC playbook.

INDEPENDENT SECURITY RESEARCHER

YesWeHack Bug Bounty, Deezer Production API Disclosure

Aug 2025

Responsible Disclosure

- Discovered a critical Insecure Direct Object Reference (IDOR) / Broken Access Control vulnerability in Deezer's production API by manipulating JSON POST parameters to bypass backend authorisation logic.
- Authored a comprehensive Proof of Concept (PoC) mapped to OWASP Top 10 (A01:2021), enabling Deezer's engineering team to deploy a global security patch within their disclosed SLA window.
- Applied systematic API endpoint behavioural analysis using Burp Suite, demonstrating advanced API security methodology directly transferable to SOC threat hunting and alert triage workflows.

KEY PROJECTS & SIMULATIONS

SOC Auto-Triage, Browser-Based Phishing Triage Platform

2026

Independent Project, React, JavaScript, MITRE ATT&CK

- Built a client-side phishing email analyser that parses .eml files, extracts IOCs (URLs, domains, IPs, attachments, SPF/DKIM/DMARC results), renders a sandboxed HTML body preview, and auto-maps indicators to MITRE ATT&CK techniques (T1566.001/002, T1656, T1071.001, T1598.003, T1036, T1534) with confidence-scored evidence trails.
- Engineered automated SIEM hunt query generation in KQL (Microsoft Defender XDR / Sentinel Advanced Hunting schema: EmailEvents, EmailUrlInfo, EmailAttachmentInfo, DeviceNetworkEvents, ThreatIntelligenceIndicator) and SPL (Splunk) for sender pivoting, click-through detection, and tenant-wide IOC sweeps.
- Implemented a weighted 0 to 100 threat-scoring engine combining authentication posture, MITRE technique confidence, and atomic risk indicators (lookalike domains, Reply-To mismatches, free hosting providers, URL shorteners); shipped STIX 2.1 / CSV IOC exports, defanged URL toggle, sandboxed attachment viewer, and PDF investigation reports mirroring a 15-field SOC L1 triage workflow.

Enterprise Phishing & Data Exfiltration Investigation, TryHackMe

Dec 2025

- Reconstructed the full Cyber Kill Chain from initial phishing access through DNS tunnelling exfiltration across a simulated compromised enterprise endpoint using EDR concepts and Sysmon log forensics.
- Decoded Base64 payloads, uncovered obfuscated PowerShell execution chains, and mapped all attacker TTPs to MITRE ATT&CK, producing a structured detection gap analysis with actionable rule recommendations.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified SOC Analyst Level 1 (TryHackMe) • Junior Penetration Tester (TryHackMe) • Fortinet Certified Associate in Cybersecurity (FCA) • ISO/IEC 27001 Information Security Associate (SkillFront) • CyberSecurity 101 (TryHackMe) • Linux 100: Fundamentals (TCM Security)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Lahore Garrison University

2020 to 2025

Lahore, Pakistan